

Resolution

ENROLLED HOUSE

RESOLUTION NO. 1040

By: West (Josh)

A Resolution recognizing and honoring Joseph Castiglione for his many contributions to the University of Oklahoma and the State of Oklahoma; and directing distribution.

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione concluded his 28 years as the University of Oklahoma's Vice President and Director of Athletics in February 2026, the longest tenure among Football Bowl Subdivision schools; and

WHEREAS, the past 28 years has represented an era of unmatched academic and athletic excellence by Sooner sports programs; and

WHEREAS, under Joseph Castiglione, nearly 3,000 student-athletes earned OU degrees; and

WHEREAS, under Joseph Castiglione, the Sooners won 117 conference titles and 26 of the University's 45 (or 58%) all-time national championships (nine by men's gymnastics, eight by softball, seven by women's gymnastics and one each by football and men's golf); and

WHEREAS, OU Athletics enjoyed 28 consecutive terms of a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher and eight straight semesters of a 3.2 or higher under Joseph Castiglione's watch, with student-athletes setting a program-record 3.31 cumulative GPA during the Spring 2025 semester; and

WHEREAS, during OU's 26 years as a member of the Big 12 Conference while Joseph Castiglione served as the school's athletics director, the Sooners amassed 15 Big 12 Athletes of the Year - more than any other program; and

WHEREAS, four Sooners won Heisman Trophies during Joseph Castiglione's tenure (Jason White in 2003, Sam Bradford in 2008, Baker Mayfield in 2017 and Kyler Murray in 2018); and

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has added to the rich tradition of coaching excellence at the University of Oklahoma with the hires of exemplary coaches, including Bob Stoops, Oklahoma's all-time winningest football coach; and

WHEREAS, during Joseph Castiglione's time as athletics director, the football program won 14 Big 12 Conference championships (10 more than the program with the next most) and the 2000 national title, and the men's (two) and women's (three) basketball programs combined for five Final Four appearances; and

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has hired and mentored dozens of former employees who went on to serve as athletics directors and senior-level administrators at other institutions; and

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has been a national leader in collegiate athletics, including service on the College Football Playoff Committee and the NCAA Division I Men's Basketball and Baseball committees, making him the first person in history to serve on those three, in addition to many others; and

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione is a sought-after voice in collegiate athletics who served on multiple NCAA committees and commissions designed to improve the overall student-athlete experience; and

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has demonstrated great leadership through a range of challenges and opportunities, including the creation of the Big 12 Conference and seismic conference realignment with OU's move to the Southeastern Conference; and

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione ensured OU Athletics remained one of the few self-sustaining departments in the country, making it a model of fiscal responsibility and an engine of support for the university at-large; and

WHEREAS, the University of Oklahoma has enjoyed the renovation and building of a variety of athletics facilities under Joseph Castiglione's leadership, including a \$160 million renovation of Gaylord Family - Oklahoma Memorial Stadium and the construction of Love's Field, Headington Family Tennis Center and Wadley Indoor

Tennis Pavilion, Griffin Family Performance Center for men's and women's basketball, Headington Hall, and more; and

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione demonstrated his commitment to excellence in the classroom by serving as an adjunct professor in OU's Jeannine Rainbolt College of Education, teaching graduate courses in marketing and higher education leadership; and

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione is a seven-time national athletics director of the year who earned multiple additional honors, including the National Football Foundation and College Hall of Fame's prestigious John L. Toner Award and induction into the Oklahoma Sports Hall of Fame, among others; and

WHEREAS, in his 28 years at OU, Joseph Castiglione provided humble, steady leadership in a moment of unprecedented change and disruption in collegiate athletics.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE 2ND SESSION OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE:

THAT the Oklahoma House of Representatives recognizes and honors Joseph Castiglione for his many contributions to the University of Oklahoma and the State of Oklahoma.

THAT a copy of this resolution be distributed to Joseph Harroz, Jr., President of the University of Oklahoma.

Adopted by the House of Representatives the 24th day of March,
2026.

Presiding Officer of the House of
Representatives

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____
day of _____, 20 _____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____